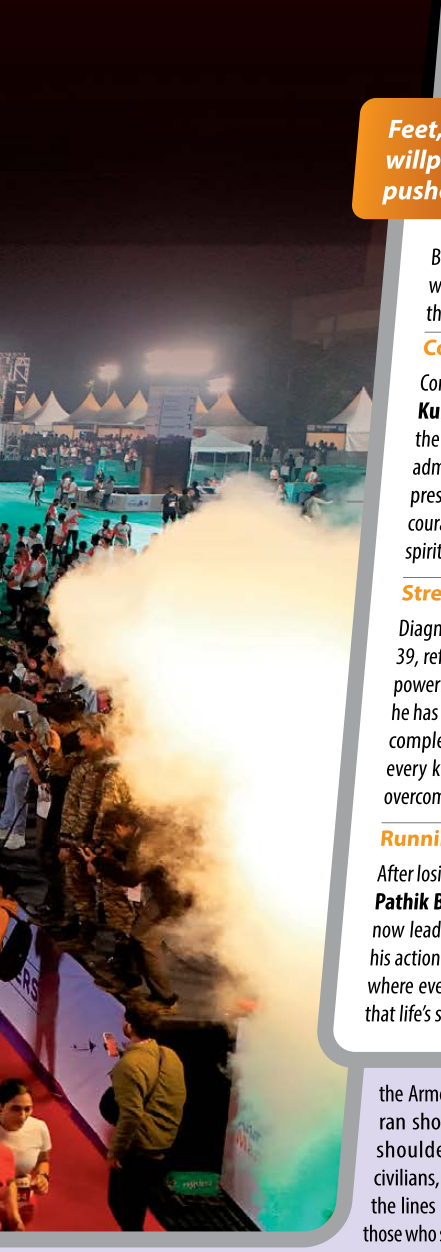


Feet, wheels and willpower: Stories that pushed beyond limits

Behind every km of the 9th Adani Ahmedabad Marathon were extraordinary stories of courage, determination and the unstoppable human spirit.

Courage Has No Boundaries

Completing his first marathon in a wheelchair, ***Kunjan Mehta*** *(in picture on right) brought the same fearless spirit that earned him national admiration for a bungee jump earlier this year. His presence on the course reminded everyone that true courage transcends physical limitations and the human spirit, when determined, can overcome any obstacle.*

Strength Beyond Endurance

Diagnosed with polio at eight months, ***Ashok Parmar,*** *39, refused to let circumstances define him. A bodybuilder, powerlifter, and long-distance runner from a farmer's family, he has participated in multiple marathons. Since 2023, he has completed three Adani Ahmedabad Marathons, turning every kilometre into a testament that true strength lies in overcoming the impossible.*

Running on Resilience

After losing both legs in a 2009 accident, 41-year-old entrepreneur ***Pathik Bhandari*** *rebuilt his life. Running prosthetic-assisted, he now leads a medical device company and inspires many through his action. This year marked his first Adani Ahmedabad Marathon, where every step radiated determination, hope and the message that life's setbacks are not the end but the beginning of courage.*





More than 24,000 runners took part this year.

the Armed Forces ran shoulder to shoulder with civilians, blurring the lines between those who serve and those who honour.

Among the day's highlights was India cricketer and Gujarat Giants' latest signee, Yastika Bhatia, who said: "It's an incredible feeling to be selected by my home franchise… The Adani Ahmedabad Marathon really feels like a festival celebrating fitness and national pride. I'm grateful to be part of the Adani family."

Strides of Gratitude and Triumph

As the kilometres unfolded, the emotion of Operation Sindoor echoed through the course. Every step felt like a salute, every breath a tribute.

Mr Pranav Adani reflected: "Since 2017, the Ahmedabad Marathon has become a landmark event… This year, the message of #Run4OurSoldiers resonated even more deeply as our Armed Forces stood tall during Operation Sindoor."

Major General Gaurav Bagga added, "Such overwhelming participation is not merely about numbers; it reflects the unity, discipline and positive spirit that define India."

Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor shared, "This event is a testament to the importance we place on fitness… The overwhelming response and energy on display today is really impressive."

The day also welcomed voices from India's sporting and cultural community. Mandira Bedi said, "The energy was electric… The Adani Group has played a key role in nurturing this growth."

Gagan Narang added, "Adani is doing exemplary work to strengthen India's sporting culture."

Preeti Jhangiani remarked, "The energy today was incredible… I'm sure next year's milestone edition will be even more special."

Families ran hand in hand, colleagues pushed each other forward and strangers became companions — united by purpose, pride and gratitude. In every runner's face was a quiet fire, in every cheer a shared conviction: that this was more than a marathon; it was Ahmedabad speaking in one voice.

Art, Identity and a Tribute in Motion

One of this edition's unforgettable highlights was the official marathon jersey designed by Wani. Debuted at Palladium Mall in Ahmedabad, it was more than apparel — it was storytelling stitched with patriotism and sustainability. Wani invited city residents to share design ideas, transforming the jersey into a piece of collective imagination.

Adding to the festival-like atmosphere was a stunning installation made from 15,000 recycled plastic bottle caps, inspired by the colours of the Indian flag — a symbol of creativity, community and conscious design.

Wani said, "Seeing thousands wear the jersey we created together with the people of Ahmedabad was truly special… Watching the city run in something we built as a community felt like the most meaningful reward."

The marathon's prestigious certification by the Athletics Federation of India (AFI) and its recognition by the Association of International Marathons and Distance Races (AIMS) further elevates its status, placing Ahmedabad firmly on the global distance-running map. This year, empowered by the courage of Operation Sindoor, every kilometre carried a deeper meaning.

As the 9th edition drew to a memorable close, anticipation for the 10-year milestone began building. A decade of gratitude, fitness and national pride awaits.

For Ahmedabad, this marathon is no longer an event — it is an emotion. A ritual of belonging. A shared promise to honour those who serve. The 9th Adani Ahmedabad Marathon was not just a race; it was a living tribute, a festival of hearts and feet and a reminder of what it means to run with purpose and gratitude.

WINNERS

FULL OPEN MARATHON

Female

1. Ashvini Jadhav (02:56:49)
2. Bharti (03:03:56)
3. Jyoti Gawate (03:09:03)

Male

1. Nikhil Singh (02:22:49)
2. Sachin Poojary (02:29:14)
3. Mohmmad Sahil Annigeri (02:30:36)

DEFENCE OPEN MARATHON

Female

1. Pooja (03:10:16)
2. Nupur Janu (03:35:42)
3. Neha Devi (03:42:30)

Male

1. Mohit Kumar Sharma (02:27:14)
2. Dinesh Singh (02:28:02)
3. Nazeem P (02:28:07)

*(hours:minutes:seconds)